

Unit 4 assessment

Unit summary

A professional standard is a written, shared, evidence-specific statement of what competent practice looks like. It differs from a code of conduct, which governs behaviour, and from a curriculum, which governs content. It does not prescribe method. Standards serve four uses - initial training, continuing development, appraisal and public accountability - and those uses pull against one another, which is the source of most complaints that standards are irrelevant bureaucracy.

Pakistan's National Professional Standards for Teachers, issued in 2009 by the Ministry of Education with UNESCO and USAID support, are the framework this country's teacher education is accredited against. They are built in three levels: ten standards, each divided into knowledge and understanding, dispositions, and performance and skills, with indicators stating observably what meeting a part looks like. The three-part division separates knowing, valuing and being able to do. Good indicators are observable, specific and achievable, and there is a standing trade-off in which the easiest indicators to check are the most likely to measure a producible proxy.

Self-evaluation is a five-station cycle run on one indicator at a time: choose, collect, judge, change, re-collect. It breaks by taking on too much and by improving the record rather than the practice. Kinds of evidence are not equivalent, and triangulating two that fail differently beats collecting one thoroughly.

Certification confirms preparation, licensing confirms current permission to practise, and appraisal is the recurring judgement of serving practice. Appraisal serves formative and summative purposes whose requirements are incompatible in one document: candour against comparability, a trusted appraiser against a distant one, weakness against strength. A combined instrument will be treated as summative and the formative value lost. The remedy is separate, deliberately connected processes rather than abandoning accountability.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. A professional standard answers which question? (*Understand*) a) How should I behave? b) What should pupils learn? c) What does competent practice look like, in a checkable form? d) Which teaching method is correct?
2. "Be a good teacher" fails as a standard chiefly because it is not: (*Remember*) a) written down b) shared across schools c) specific enough to be evidenced d) approved by a ministry
3. A framework built for continuing development is used to decide promotions. This is best described as: (*Apply*) a) efficient reuse of an existing instrument b) applying a standard for a use it was not designed for c) a breach of the code of conduct d) summative appraisal working as intended
4. Pakistan's National Professional Standards for Teachers were issued in: (*Remember*) a) 1999 by the Higher Education Commission b) 2009 by the Ministry of Education c) 2015 by NACTE d) 2009 by UNESCO alone
5. Each of Pakistan's standards is internally divided into: (*Remember*) a) aims, methods and outcomes b) knowledge and understanding, dispositions, and performance and skills c) novice, proficient and expert levels d) primary, elementary and secondary bands
6. Which is the strongest indicator for a learning-environment standard? (*Apply*) a) Maintains a positive classroom climate b) Displays pupils' work on the classroom walls c) Pupils volunteer answers, including incorrect ones, without prompting d) Keeps an up-to-date seating plan
7. In the self-evaluation cycle, evidence is collected before the judgement is formed because: (*Understand*) a) it is quicker b) a judgement formed first selects the evidence that confirms it c) the appraiser requires it in that order d) evidence is harder to collect afterwards
8. Which evidence type is easiest to produce without the underlying competence? (*Understand*) a) Pupil work b) Pupil voice c) Planning documents d) Observation by a colleague

9. Licensing differs from certification chiefly in that licensing asks:
(*Understand*) a) was this person prepared? b) is this person currently fit to practise? c) how is this person doing this year? d) which subject may this person teach?
10. A single appraisal document serving both formative and summative purposes will in practice be treated by teachers as: (*Understand*) a) formative, because development matters more b) summative, because that is the version with consequences c) neither, because it will be ignored d) both equally

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Define a professional standard and name the three features that make one usable. (*Remember*)
2. Distinguish a professional standard, a code of conduct and a curriculum by the question each answers and what each governs. (*Understand*)
3. Name the four uses a standard is put to and state what each use requires of the standard. (*Remember*)
4. Explain why a standard designed for development and one designed for accountability cannot fully be the same document. (*Analyze*)
5. Describe the three-level architecture of Pakistan's National Professional Standards. (*Remember*)
6. Explain what separating knowledge, dispositions and performance within a standard buys that a single judgement would not. (*Understand*)
7. Give three tests of a good indicator, and explain why an indicator that is easy to check is often worse. (*Analyze*)
8. Name the five stations of the self-evaluation cycle and identify the two places it commonly breaks. (*Remember*)
9. For any three evidence types, state what each shows well, what it cannot show, and how easily it can be produced without the competence.
(*Understand*)

10. Explain why a mentor who also writes a teacher's appraisal is less useful as a mentor, and what this costs a school. (*Analyze*)

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. A district must decide whether to confirm two probationary teachers, one well-liked with a quiet class and one difficult with adequate results. Argue whether introducing a written standard would improve that decision, addressing the objection that evidence requirements favour the compliant over the effective. (*Evaluate*)
2. **Integrative.** A teacher is described as follows: she plans thoroughly, marks late, knows her subject well, rarely changes her approach when pupils struggle, and has a warm but quiet classroom in which four pupils do all the answering. Map this practice to specific standards and to the knowledge, dispositions or performance part in each case, then argue what her appraisal should say and what her development priority should be. (*Analyze*)
3. Write an indicator for any standard that is observable, specific and achievable in an under-resourced government school. Then explain in detail how a teacher could satisfy it without the underlying competence, and revise the indicator to close that gap. (*Create*)
4. Nadia's self-evaluation was complete and useless; Kashif's looked worse and was not. Evaluate both, diagnose what in a school's handling produces Nadia's behaviour, and design arrangements that would produce more Kashifs while preserving accountability. (*Evaluate*)
5. A province decides that the annual developmental self-evaluation will now also determine promotions. Evaluate the reform, trace the mechanism by which it degrades the record, and propose an alternative that still delivers evidence-based promotion. Address the objection that two separate processes are unaffordable. (*Evaluate*)

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **c** - a standard governs practice; (a) is a code of conduct and (b) a curriculum.
2. **c** - it fails the evidence-specificity test; it could be written and shared and still be unusable.
3. **b** - the four uses make this diagnosis available, and it is the province's error in Topic 4.4.
4. **b** - Ministry of Education, 2009, with UNESCO and USAID support.
5. **b** - knowledge and understanding; dispositions; performance and skills.
6. **c** - observable, specific, and genuinely hard to produce without the competence; (b) is the proxy trap.
7. **b** - order protects against confirmation, which is why Kashif counted before concluding.
8. **c** - planning documents evidence an afternoon's writing, not a term's teaching.
9. **b** - licensing is about current permission and can be renewable; certification is about preparation.
10. **b** - rational response to where the consequences sit, not a failure of maturity.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

- 1. (4 marks)** Definition as a written statement of expected knowledge, values and practice (1); written (1); shared (1); specific enough to be evidenced (1).
- 2. (6 marks)** Two marks per instrument: the question it answers and what it governs. Standard: what competent practice looks like, governs practice. Code: how to behave, governs conduct. Curriculum: what pupils learn, governs content.
- 3. (8 marks)** One mark per use named (4); one mark per apt requirement (4). Initial training needs alignment with preparation; development needs generosity and safety; appraisal needs precision and evidence; accountability needs a public claim.

4. (4 marks) Development needs candour and appraisal penalises it (1); development is best with a trusted appraiser, accountability needs distance (1); development targets weakness, accountability invites strength (1); concludes that one document cannot hold both sets of requirements (1).

5. (4 marks) Ten standards (1); each divided into knowledge, dispositions, performance (2); indicators beneath, stating observably what meeting a part looks like (1).

6. (4 marks) Identifies three distinct shortfalls: not knowing, not valuing, not able (2); explains that each has a different remedy (1); notes that a single judgement hides which applies (1).

7. (5 marks) Observable, specific to the standard, achievable under real conditions (3); easy indicators tend to measure proxies (1); proxies can be produced without the competence (1).

8. (7 marks) Choose one indicator, collect evidence, judge the gap, plan one change, re-collect the same evidence (5); breaks by taking on too many indicators (1); breaks by changing the evidence rather than the practice (1).

9. (9 marks) Three marks per evidence type: what it shows, what it cannot show, ease of production without competence.

10. (4 marks) A teacher will not bring a real problem to someone who reports on them (1); the mentoring relationship is the cheapest effective development mechanism a school has (1); its loss is invisible because nothing visibly fails (1); the school retains the appearance of mentoring without the function (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response not reaching "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall.

ERQ 1 - Would a standard improve the confirmation decision?

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Grasp of the concept	Praises standards generally	Uses the three features	Shows what specifically changes in the head's report
Identification of use	Not addressed	Names the use	Shows why the use determines what the standard must contain
Objection engaged (Evaluate)	Ignored or dismissed	Answered	Concedes the risk that evidence favours the compliant and locates what in the design does or does not prevent it
Specificity	Abstract	Some concrete detail	States what the report would have to contain instead

ERQ 2 - Integrative mapping of a described teacher

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Standard mapping	One or two, loosely	Several, correctly	Each practice mapped to standard and to the correct internal part
Use of the three-part division	Absent	Applied once	Distinguishes knowing, valuing and being able across the described behaviours

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Appraisal judgement (Analyze)	Lists strengths and weaknesses	Reaches a judgement	Argues a single development priority and justifies why it is prior to the others
Evidence discipline	Inference as fact	Distinguishes them	Names what evidence is missing to decide

ERQ 3 - Writing and hardening an indicator

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Initial indicator	Fails a test	Meets all three tests	Achievable under genuinely constrained conditions
Gaming account	Vague	A plausible route	A route a real teacher would actually take
Revision (Create)	Cosmetic	Closes the gap	Closes it without making the indicator unobservable or unachievable
Reasoning	Asserted	Explained	Explains the proxy trade-off being managed

ERQ 4 - Two self-evaluations and a system

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Analysis of the forms	Praises honesty	Explains professional value of each	Shows why the better one looks worse
Diagnosis	Blames Nadia	Locates cause partly in the system	Locates it fully in the handling, without excusing
Design (Create)	Slogans	Concrete arrangements	Specifies separation and the defined connection, adoptable by a real school
Accountability preserved (Evaluate)	Not addressed	Addressed	Shows how accountability survives separation rather than being traded away

ERQ 5 - The province's reform

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Mechanism (Analyze)	Asserts morale falls	Describes degradation	Traces it step by step through candour, proxies and mentoring
Command of the distinction	Confused	Accurate	Precise about conflicting requirements

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Alternative (Create)	Refuses the aim	Proposes a design	Delivers the legitimate promotion aim and specifies the connection between processes
Cost objection (Evaluate)	Ignored	Acknowledged	Design survives realistic administrative capacity, or states honestly what it would require

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

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